

NOCTERNAL PLAY

BY SPLITFIRE PRODUCTION · USER GUIDE

Everything the app can do and how to use it: your music, YouTube Music, Radio Hub, free downloads, the effects, lighting, themes, the vinyl player and the Nocternal Bot.

Version 1.1.0

Android (full) · iPhone (most features)

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STEP 0

Getting started

- 1 Install the APK. Unzip the download from GitHub, open the **.apk** file and allow **Install unknown apps** for your file manager if Android asks.
- 2 Open **Nocternal Play** and allow **music access** so it can find your songs. On Android 13 and newer, also allow **notifications** so playback controls show on the lock screen.
- 3 The app scans your phone. You'll see *Scanning your music...*, then *Analyzing BPM & key*. You can play music while it works.
- 4 Use the bottom bar to move between [Home](#) [Player](#) [Lighting](#) [Settings](#).

TIP

Songs added later show up after [Settings](#) ▶ [Library](#) ▶ [Rescan music](#).

HOME

Three sliding panels

The top of Home has three tabs. Tap one, or swipe left and right to slide between them:

- **Local:** the music on your phone, plus *Continue listening*, *Ideas*, genre tiles and your library.
- **YouTube Music:** the YouTube Music website inside the app.
- **Radio Hub:** tens of thousands of internet stations and an FM-style dial.

While music plays, a **mini-player** sits above the bottom bar. Tap it to open the full player, or use its play/pause and next buttons. The sparkle icon on the player screen opens the [Nocturnal Bot](#).

On the Local panel

- **Continue listening**: tap a card to pick up where you were.
- **↓ Free music & podcasts**: opens [free downloads](#).
- **Ideas**: tap a ✨ chip (such as a morning or focus playlist) and the bot builds and plays it.
- **Genres**: 18 tiles. If you own songs in that genre, the tile says *N songs* and plays them. If not, it says *Radio* and opens matching stations.

HOME ▶ LOCAL ▶ LIBRARY

Your library

Use the chips under *Library* to switch views:

Songs

Every song, with BPM and musical key once analysed. Tap to play. ♥ marks favourites.

Playlists

Tap a playlist to drop down its songs. Tap ▶ Play to play it all, or a song to start from there.

Folders

Browse your storage folders. Tap ▶ Play folder to play everything inside; ⬅ goes up.

History

A day-by-day timeline of what you played and for how long. Nothing is recorded in private mode.

Smart playlists (made for you automatically)

- **Favorites**: songs you've liked with ♥ in the player.
- **Recently played** and **Most played**: skips don't count.
- **Mood** playlists, built from each song's detected mood.
- **Genre** playlists: one for each of the 18 genres, sorted using the song's genre tag, its folder name, then title/artist words, then tempo.

PLAYER TAB

The player

The cover spins as a real vinyl record: black disc, grooves and a glossy rim, with the song's own artwork (or a generated neon cover) as the round label in the centre. A tonearm swings onto the record when a song is playing and lifts away when it's

paused. **Long-press any button in the player to see its name** — every icon has a tooltip.

- Play/pause, next, previous and a seek bar. Shuffle and repeat (off → all → one).
- ♥ adds the song to Favorites.
- **Lyrics** button: shows synced lyrics (see [Lyrics](#)).
- **EQ**: opens [EQ & FX](#).
- **Sleep timer** (moon icon): stop after 15, 30, 60 or 90 minutes, or at the end of the song. The music fades out gently.
- **DJ auto-mix** (sliders icon): tap to turn on/off. It picks the next song by matching BPM and key, so songs blend like a DJ set. **Long-press it** to open the personal DJ mixer menu: choose *Keep energy steady* or *Build energy ↑*, and see why the current track was picked (key/tempo match, blend length).
- **Nocturnal Bot** (sparkle icon): opens the bot — see [Nocturnal Bot](#).
- ☐ collapses back to where you were.

Music keeps playing in the background, with controls on the lock screen, in notifications and on Bluetooth headsets.

PLAYER ▶ LYRICS

Lyrics

Lyrics scroll in time with the song and highlight the current line. They come from, in order:

1. A saved copy on your phone (works offline).
2. A **.lrc** file with the same name next to the song.
3. The free LRCLIB lyrics library online: exact match first, then a fuzzy search.
4. If no real lyrics exist, **AI-written lyrics**. With a Claude key they're written by Claude, otherwise on the phone. They're marked with a banner and are original lines in the song's style, not the real song. If real lyrics turn up later, they replace them.

HINDI & PUNJABI SONGS

Lyrics are always shown in English letters. If the real lyrics come back in Devanagari or Gurmukhi script (Hindi/Punjabi), the app automatically transliterates them into Hinglish/Punglish — the same words, sounded out in English letters, never translated. The same applies to AI-written lyrics: for a detected Hindi/Punjabi song, the AI writes in Hinglish, never plain English.

PLAYER ▶ EQ

Equalizer & effects

- **10-band EQ** (31 Hz – 16 kHz) with **30 presets** — genre picks like *Rock, Pop, Jazz, Classical, Hip-hop, Acoustic* and *Metal*, mood/use picks like *EDM punch, Lo-fi warm, Vocal clarity* and *Podcast voice*, plus *Treble boost, Bass reducer* and *Live concert*.
- **AI optimize**: picks EQ settings for the current song and for speaker vs headphones.
- **FX grid**: bass boost, 3D surround, stereo widening, loudness, pitch shift and vocal remover (karaoke).
- **Reverb, Compressor, Flanger, Phaser**, each with its own sliders.
- **Enhance** (AI song enhancer): clarity, noise removal, bass, vocal focus and old-recording restore.

EQ presets are picked manually or by the bot (say "recommend eq" or "apply rock eq") — the EQ no longer changes automatically when the theme switches.

SETTINGS ▶ PLAYBACK

Crossfade & gapless

With **Crossfade (next song overlaps, no gaps)** on, the next song starts before the current one ends, and the two blend smoothly. There's no silence between songs.

- Set the overlap with the slider (0-30 seconds). **4-6 s** suits playlists and mixes; go longer for a slow, DJ-style blend.
- Set **0 s** for live albums and DJ sets: songs join exactly, with no gap.
- **Smart audio normalization** evens out loudness so no song jumps out.
- **Speaker boost** makes the phone speaker louder. **Hearing & speaker safe mode** caps the peak volume.

On iPhone, songs play gapless back-to-back; the overlapping crossfade is Android only.

HOME ▶ YOUTUBE MUSIC

YouTube Music

This is the real YouTube Music website inside the app. Sign in with your Google account to get your playlists and likes. Search and play as usual; the neon theme changes with what you play.

Downloading from YouTube and blocking YouTube ads aren't included, because YouTube's terms don't allow it. For offline music, use [Free downloads](#).

HOME ▶ RADIO HUB

Radio Hub

Free internet radio from open directories: **Radio Browser** (about 50,000 stations worldwide), **SomaFM** (ad-free channels) and the **Icecast** directory. Tap any station to play it.

By genre

The 18 app genres, plus the most popular tags. Add a country chip to narrow it down, e.g. Bollywood stations in India.

By country

All countries with flags and station counts. Type in *Find a country*, pick one, then filter by genre.

SomaFM

Listener-supported, commercial-free channels such as Groove Salad and Drone Zone.

FM dial

A tuning dial with FM stations from the chosen country that stream online, sorted by frequency.

The search box at the top searches every source at once.

HOME ► LOCAL ► FREE MUSIC & PODCASTS

Free downloads

Download music that is legal to keep. Everything here is Creative Commons or public domain, or a free podcast episode. Downloads play offline like your own songs.

Tabs

- **Internet Archive:** works without setup. Search, or tap a genre chip (electronic, ambient, lofi, rock, jazz, Indian...). Tap an album to see its songs.
- **Jamendo:** about 600,000 songs by independent artists. It needs a free client ID, set up once (below).
- **Podcasts:** search any show, or tap a starter chip (music, Bollywood, tech, comedy...). Tap a show to see its episodes.
- **Downloaded:** everything you've saved, with [Credit](#) and [Delete](#). Tap a song to play the whole list.

Download a song

- 1 Tap a song's title or picture to **stream a preview** first, if you like.
- 2 Tap [Get](#). A progress bar appears. [Cancel](#) stops it; [Retry](#) shows if it fails.
- 3 When it says ✓ **Saved**, the song is in your library under [Library](#) ► [Folders](#) ► [Free downloads](#), with lyrics, EQ, crossfade and themes like any other song.

Set up Jamendo (one time)

- 1 Go to **devportal.jamendo.com** and create a free account and app.
- 2 Copy its **Client ID**.
- 3 Paste it in **Settings** ▶ **Free music** ▶ **Jamendo client ID** and tap **Save client ID**.

LICENCES

Every song shows its licence (for example *CC BY-SA 4.0*) and a *source* ↗ link. If you share or reuse a song, credit the artist; the app keeps a **CREDITS.txt** list of all your downloads. Licences with **NC** don't allow commercial use. For example, don't use them in a monetised YouTube video. Podcast episodes are for personal listening only.

LIGHTING TAB

Light bar & edge lighting

Light bar

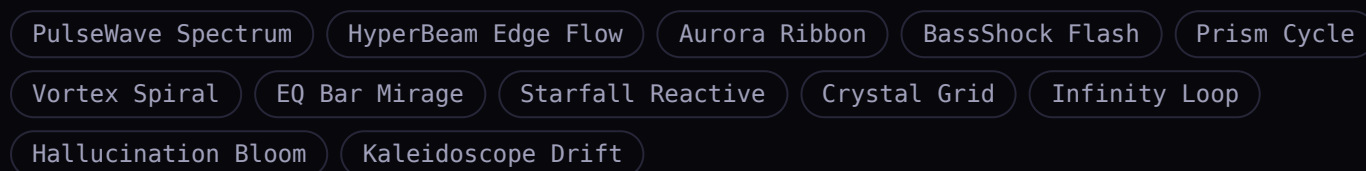
A glowing bar that pulses with the music. Turn it on or off, pick a colour and set the glow strength.

Edge lighting

Neon light around the screen edges. Modes: **Static**, **Gradient** and **Music reactive**, with sliders for **thickness** and **brightness**.

Your settings are kept. Genre themes won't reset them. To let the theme choose again, tap **Follow genre theme again**, or **Light bar: follow genre theme again** for the bar.

The 12 animations



Also here: **Full-screen visualizer behind the player**, the **Neon theme presets** list (every preset is maxed out — full glow, music-reactive edges, the thickest/brightest settings — tap one to apply it) and **Resume automatic themes** after picking one by hand.

THEMES

Themes & genres

Pick a theme yourself from the Lighting tab's preset list, or switch it per genre with a genre tile or playlist. Automatic switching by a song's detected genre is **off by**

default now, so your theme choice sticks between songs — turn it back on with the bot ("turn on auto theme by genre") if you'd rather it follow each song. Switching by AI-detected mood or by time of day are separate toggles and stay available in Settings.

GENRE	THEME
 Devotional	Sacred Gold Aura
 Meditation	Emerald Tranquility
 Sleep	Moonlit Cyan Drift
 Hindi Classics	Royal Purple Gold
 EDM	Electric Blue Pulse
 Trance	Violet Hyperspace
 Techno	Cyber Red Pulse
 Night Drive	Blue-Purple Galaxy
 Lo-Fi	Soft Pink Glow
 Chillout	Aqua Drift
 Ambient	Deep Space Indigo
 Workout	Volt Lime Surge
 Focus	Laser Focus Teal
 Romantic	Rose Neon Heart
 Party Mix	Rainbow Rave
 Morning Vibes	Sunrise Amber
 Instrumental	Silver Strings
 Podcast Mode	Studio Mono Blue

Every preset above now runs maxed out — full glow, music-reactive edge lighting, the thickest/brightest settings and the **PulseWave Spectrum** light bar. The default (no genre detected) theme uses the **Hallucination Bloom** animation instead.

Theme modes ([Settings](#) ► [Theme](#)): **Light**, **Dark**, **Neon**, **AMOLED Black**. Pick your own accent colour, or leave it on **Auto (genre)**.

Nocturnal Bot

The bot runs **entirely on your phone** — no account, no API key, no internet needed. Tap the sparkle icon, then type or tap the mic and speak. Besides playing music, it's now also a one-stop way to **change any app setting**:

- “Play trance playlist”
- “Boost bass”
- “Activate meditation theme”
- “play something happy”
- “lofi bajao”
- “switch to radio”
- “skip”
- “remove the noise from this track”
- “explain what is gapless playback”
- “turn on gapless”
- “turn off private mode”
- “enable speaker safe mode”
- “crossfade to 8 seconds”

It can suggest playlists by genre, mood, BPM or time of day; recommend or apply any EQ preset; explain audio features; switch sources; run the enhancer; and flip any toggle in Settings — gapless, normalization, speaker safe mode, private mode, auto theme by genre/mood/time, theme-sets-EQ, Wi-Fi/mobile data use, auto-download lyrics or artwork — by name, from this one place.

What's this song? Music recognition listens through the mic. On Android it needs a free **audd.io** token in **Settings > AI lyrics**; on iPhone it uses Shazam.

ABOUT THE CLAUDE KEY

The bot itself needs nothing from you. A Claude API key in **Settings > AI lyrics** is optional and only used to write lyrics (in Hinglish for Hindi/Punjabi songs) when no real lyrics can be found — it is never sent your commands or used for chat.

SETTINGS TAB

Settings, section by section

SECTION	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Theme	Theme mode, accent colour, auto theme by AI mood / time of day. (Auto theme by genre and theme-sets-EQ are off by default and no longer have switches here — turn them back on through the bot if you want them.)
Playback	Crossfade on/off and overlap seconds (0–30 s).
Sound	Smart normalization, speaker boost, hearing & speaker safe mode.
Sleep timer	15 / 30 / 60 / 90 minutes, or Off.
Floating mini-player	Show bubble puts a draggable neon bubble over other apps (allow “display over other apps”); Hide removes it.

Privacy & offline	Private mode, smart offline mode, Use Wi-Fi , Use mobile data (both on by default; untick one to block it), auto-download lyrics, background downloads on Wi-Fi only, clear history.
AI lyrics	Claude API key (optional, for AI-written/Hinglish lyrics only — the bot itself doesn't need it), music recognition token.
Free music	Jamendo client ID.
Plugins	Turn on the built-in plugins: Scrobbler, Pomodoro focus timer, Beat counter.
Backup & restore	Save settings, playlists, favourites and history to a file. Restore with Merge or Replace , even on another phone or an iPhone.
Library	Rescan music after adding songs.

ALSO BUILT IN

More features

Smart offline mode

Without internet, online panels say so and your music, saved lyrics and downloads keep working.

Smart auto-download

Fetches lyrics for your most-played and recent songs in the background, on Wi-Fi if you choose.

Private mode

No history, no scrobbles and no online lyric lookups; history is left out of backups.

Mood detection

Guesses each song's mood to build Mood playlists and optionally change the theme.

BPM & key analysis

Measured on the phone and shown on each song. It powers DJ auto-mix.

Cosmic backgrounds

Nine animated backgrounds (starfield, nebula, aurora, grid horizon, rain glass...) chosen by the theme.

Plugins

Built-in add-ons that run safely. If one crashes, the app keeps playing.

Cross-platform backup

An Android backup restores on iPhone and the reverse. Songs are matched by artist, title and length.

IF SOMETHING'S OFF

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	TRY THIS

No songs	Allow music access in Android settings, then Settings ▶ Library ▶ Rescan music .
“You're offline”	Check Use Wi-Fi and Use mobile data in Settings ▶ Privacy & offline . If you're on mobile data, that box must be ticked.
A radio station won't play	Some stations go offline; try another. Search finds duplicates from other directories.
Jamendo tab asks for an ID	Add the free client ID (see Free downloads).
Lyrics say AI-generated / no official lyrics found	No real lyrics were found online. They're replaced when real ones appear. For Hindi/Punjabi songs they're always shown transliterated into English letters, never Devanagari/Gurmukhi script.
Lighting or theme keeps changing	Auto theme by genre is off by default, so this is usually Auto theme by AI mood or time of day in Settings ▶ Theme — turn the one you don't want off, or set lighting yourself on the Lighting tab (your values stay).
Gap or dip between songs	Turn on Crossfade and set 4–6 s, or 0 s for gapless.
Bubble doesn't appear	Allow “Display over other apps” for Nocturnal Play in Android settings.

Nocturnal Play by SplitFire Production · Guide for app version 1.1.0 (Android build from the [claude/nocturnal-playz-music-app-vwjb0](#) branch). Features marked Android-only: overlapping crossfade, free downloads, and the bubble over other apps.